

Unit 1: Explore Graphic & Visual Design

3 PROJECTS (parts) for the UNIT

1. EXPLORE: Creative Careers / or Career Paths (more than one if you want)

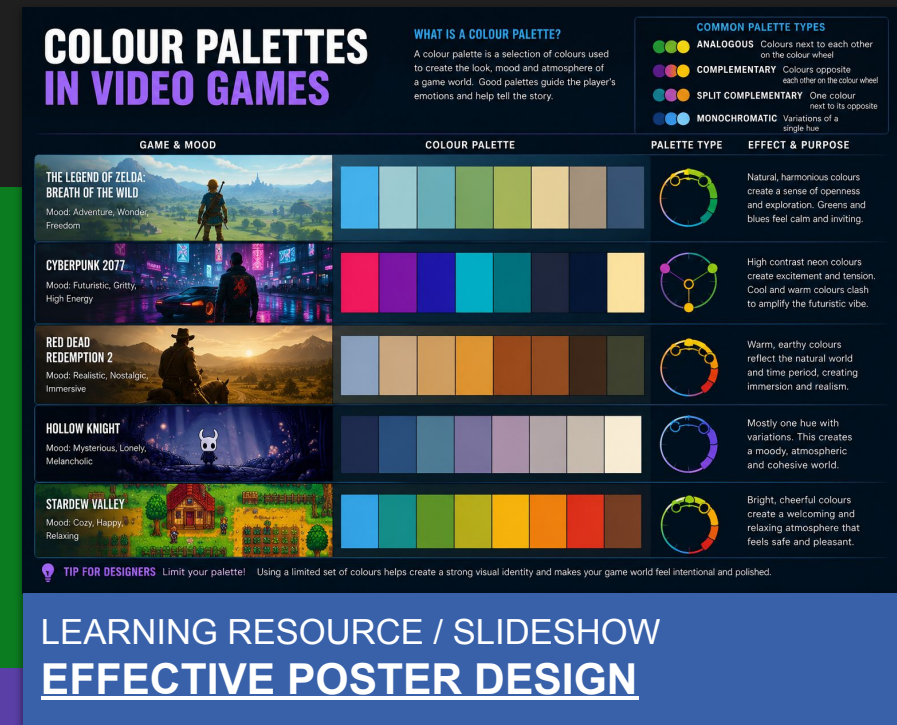
- CAREER EXPLORATION= 5 SLIDES (minimum) / Include sources
- Your 5 slides should explore (research):
 - What is the career/sector? What do people actually do or make?
 - What skills, interests and abilities connect to it?
 - What education/training/pathways can lead there?
 - What is interesting, surprising or challenging about the work?
 - Find a real person/company/example connected to the field.

2. PLANNING: Graphic Design

- PRACTICE, PROCESS & PLANNING= 5 SLIDES (minimum)
- Plan your graphic design:
 - E.g. poster, logo, social graphic, promotional design connected to a career, business, event or creative sector that interests you.
 - Effective Poster Design
- **Demonstrate:** Inspiration (Idea Starters) → Ideation → 3-5 Thumbnail ideas (minimum) → Develop
 - Some of your ideation can be AI (eg. ChatGPT/ Gemini). Be sure to clearly label which slides you've used AI
 - Some of your planning needs to be your own sketches (traditional or digital), photos, or mood boards
- **Need an Idea:**
 - If you're stuck make a logo/ wordmark for this course, or your favourite course/ subject (tie to possible career pathway)
 - Design / Type / Layout / Ideation (slides 10-19)

3. CREATE: Graphics Career Poster (bonus mark options, next slide)

- **KEY INSTRUCTIONS:** Make a careers poster and then make the poster move (motion graphics)
 - Example: How to Make a NASCAR MOTION GRAPHIC



INSTRUCTIONS

BONUS MARKS: DO MORE DESIGNS

OPTION 1: MORE POSTER DESIGNS

Design a careers/promotional poster in the style of a movie, theatrical or event poster.

OPTION 2: SOCIAL MEDIA AD CAMPAIGN

Create a social-media advertising (video or pic reel) or promotional graphic connected to the sector

OPTION 3: PROMOTIONAL DESIGN (Business or Product...)

Invent a mock business, club, event, product or organization connected to the field and promote it.

OPTION 4: LOGO / WORDMARK + APPLICATION

Design an identity for a mock business/event/organization and show it being used.

OPTION 5: COMBINE OPTIONS / SOMETHING ELSE

Pitch an idea.

- *Example: Turn yourself or a friend into the hero of a theatrical career poster and social media advertisement.*

FINAL DELIVERABLE: all 3 Projects (parts to the unit)

Create a 3 part slideshow organized with labels such as:

1. CAREER EXPLORATION= 5 SLIDES (minimum)
2. LEARN & PLAN= 5 SLIDES (minimum)
3. CREATE: Graphics Challenge= Final Deliverable
 - Submit your final project in the slideshow and as a separate file

Careers in the Arts
STUDENT EXAMPLES

LOGO + WORDMARK IDEATION

DON'T DESIGN THE FINAL LOGO FIRST.

Great logos are simple, meaningful and flexible. They start with ideas, not software.

EXPLORE. SKETCH. REFINES. REPEAT. YOUR FIRST IDEA IS NOT A SOLUTION.

1. START WITH WORDS

What should the course communicate?

CREATIVE

BOLD

CONTEMPORARY

INCLUSIVE

ENERGETIC

2. EXPLORE THE NAME - WORDMARK OPTIONS

Try different type styles, arrangements and treatments.

3. EXPLORE SYMBOLS

Quick symbol ideas. Explore shapes, initials and negative space.

4. COMBINE + REFINE

Put your strongest wordmark and symbol ideas together. Try different relationships.

REFINED DIRECTION

Simplify. Strengthen. Make it work everywhere.

LEARNING RESOURCE / SLIDESHOW

DESIGN / TYPE (Slides 1-9)

LAYOUT / IDEATION (Slides 10-19)

SUCCESS CRITERIA: Your Final Design Should

- Communicate a clear purpose/message to a specific audience
- Use relevant career/sector research in the design (or promo material)
- Create a clear visual hierarchy / focal point
- Make effective choices with colour, typography, images & layout
- Use the Elements & Principles to build an effective composition
- Demonstrate skill with digital tools/software
- develop an original idea (not just copy an existing design)
- Refine my work using planning and feedback
- Submit a polished, professional final design

REQUIREMENTS LIST: UNIT 1- Explore Graphic & Visual Design

Minimum Level 2-3 (60%-75%)

- ❑ **Complete some of the 3 Parts of the Unit**
 - Example: incomplete research, planning/process and/or final design
- ❑ **EXPLORE Creative Careers:** minimum 5-slide career/sector exploration
 - Include research, real-world examples and sources
- ❑ **LEARN & PLAN:** minimum 5 slides of process & planning
 - Inspiration / idea starters → ideation → **3–5 thumbnail ideas** → develop
- ❑ Show some original planning of your own
 - Sketches (traditional/digital), photos, mood boards and/or design experiments
- ❑ **CREATE Graphics Challenge:** complete a final graphic design
 - Poster, logo/wordmark, social graphic, promotional design or approved alternative
- ❑ Demonstrate basic use of colour, typography, layout / composition
- ❑ Show an understanding of the Elements & Principles of Design / message
- ❑ Submit an organized 3-Part Process & Planning Slideshow & Final Design

Higher Mark Level 3-4 (75%-85%)

- ❑ **Completed all 3 Parts of the Unit**
- ❑ Research is relevant, organized and clearly connected to your chosen career/creative sector
- ❑ Explore multiple ideas and layouts before choosing a final direction
- ❑ Planning clearly demonstrates the development of your idea
- ❑ Communicate a clear message through strong visual organization
- ❑ Effective and intentional choices with colour, typography, images & layout
- ❑ Use the Elements & Principles to create a strong, unified composition
- ❑ Demonstrate strong technical control of your chosen digital tools/software
- ❑ Develop an original solution rather than copying an existing design
- ❑ Show clear evidence of experimentation, problem-solving, and refinement

Excellent Mark Level 4+ (85%-100%)

- ❑ Complete all requirements with a high degree of skill and independence
- ❑ Research and inspiration meaningfully influence the final design
- ❑ Explore, compare and refine multiple creative directions before committing to a solution
- ❑ Communicate a clear, engaging message for the audience
- ❑ Demonstrate sophisticated control of visual hierarchy, typography, colour, imagery, layout and composition
- ❑ Demonstrate strong technical control and make purposeful use of digital tools/software
- ❑ Take creative risks and push the idea beyond the obvious or expected solution
- ❑ Show extensive research, process work, ideation, and refinement
 - Process & Planning demonstrates meaningful exploration, decision-making and growth
- ❑ Create a polished final design with strong visual impact and a clear creative voice
- ❑ Go beyond the minimum requirements through complexity, ambition or technical/creative challenge

EXPLORE, DEVELOP & REFINE= Stronger work

EASY MODE vs ADVANCED MODE: SOFTWARE USE

Learning Pathways

EASY MODE

Simple, Fast, Fun

- Easy Mode will not lower your mark
- It's lower pressure, not lower marks
- Create, explore, and have fun learning

Examples of Software Options:

- Canva
- Pixlr
- CapCut
- WeVideo
- ProCreate
- ibis Paint
- Alight Motion

ADVANCED MODE

More Tools. More Challenge.

- If you want a challenge try Advanced Mode
- Try Advanced Mode If you want a career in Video, Audio, or Animation
- Do it if you just want to increase your mark

Examples of Software Options:

- Photoshop / Illustrator / InDesign
- Premiere / After Effects
- DaVinci Resolve
- Blender
- Figma

Note: to use Advanced Software
Sign In to the Virtual Desktop

The Course is EFFORT DRIVEN

- Explore a range of software. Combine workflows between easy & advanced modes.
 - Getting a good mark does not mean what software you end up using to achieve your final results
 - The journey is just as important as the destination
- You're graded on skill development, exploration (trying different things), and final deliverable

EXPLORE, DEVELOP & REFINE= Stronger work



PHOTOSHOP TUTORIALS

PHOTOSHOP ESSENTIALS TUTORIALS

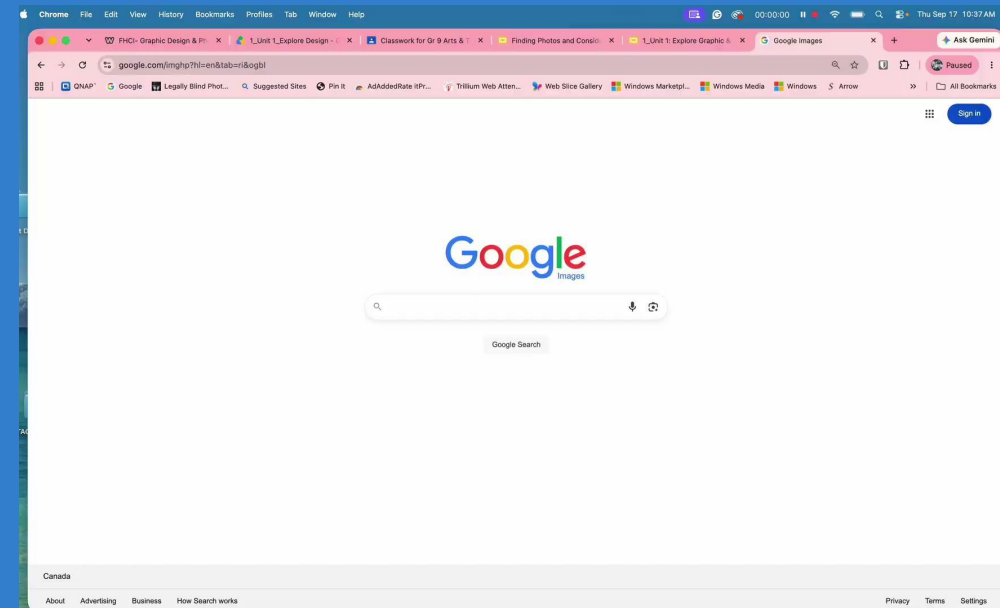
ILLUSTRATOR TUTORIALS

ILLUSTRATOR STARTER TUTORIALS

Finding Stock Photos for Your Poster & Graphics

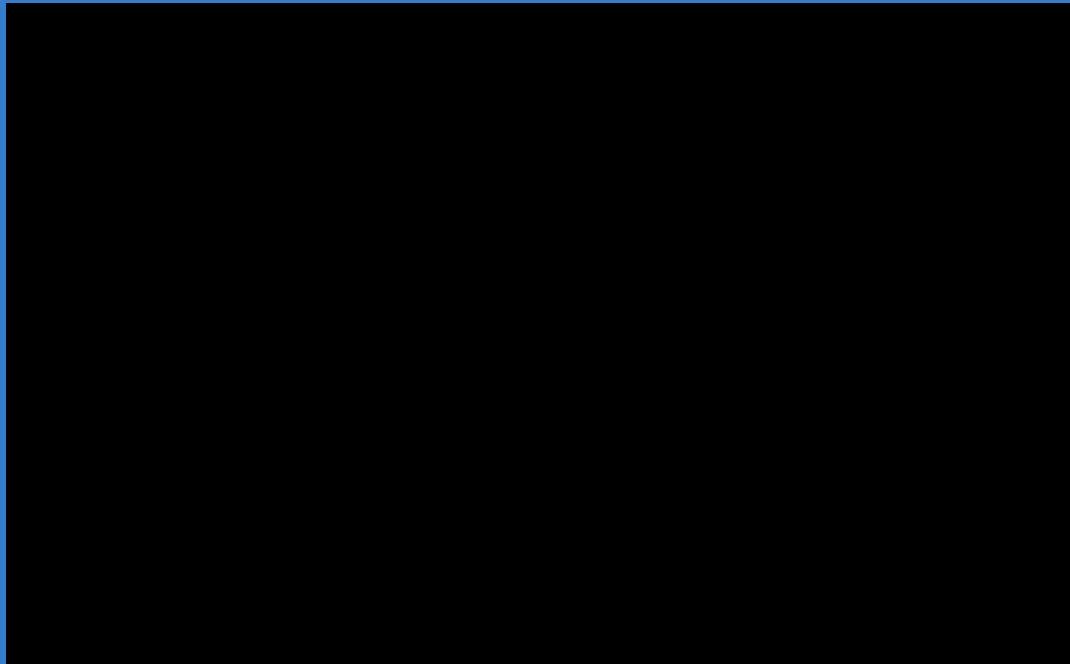
- <https://www.canva.com/photos/>
- <https://www.freepik.com/>
- <https://unsplash.com/>

Find Images from Google → Tools, Large (for Resolution)

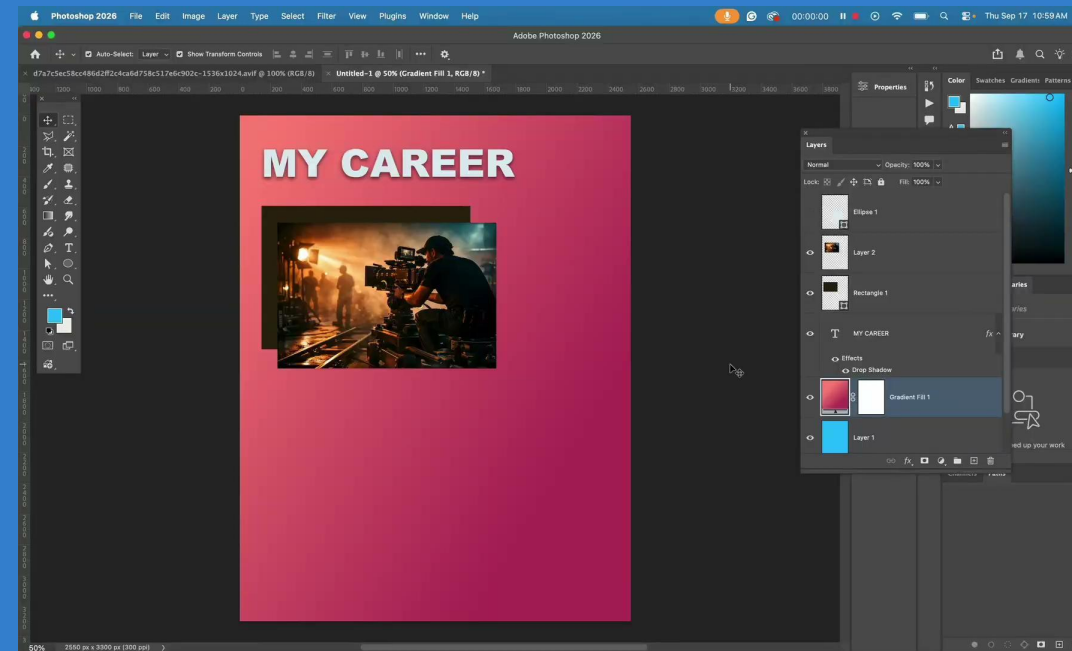
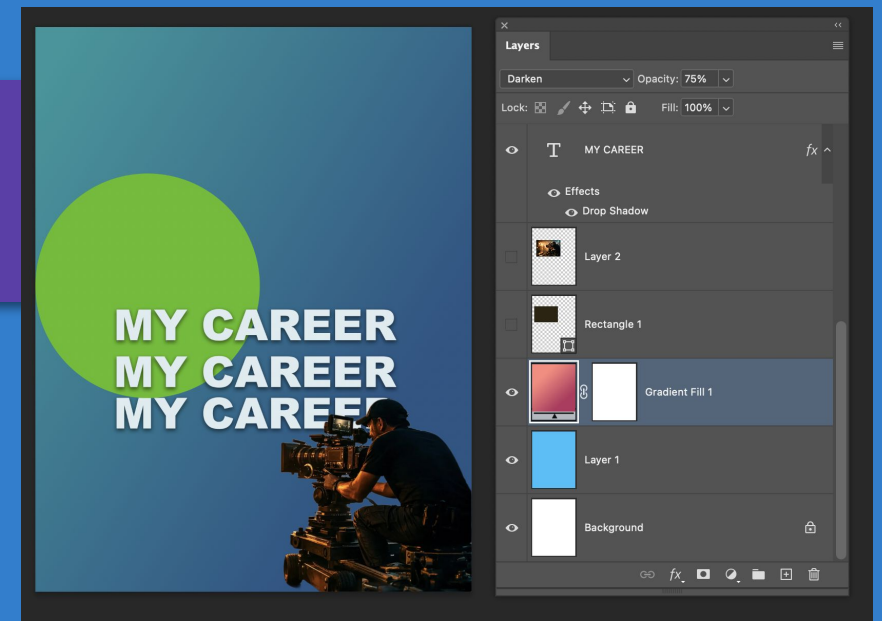


PHOTOSHOP TUTORIALS

PHOTOSHOP ESSENTIALS TUTORIALS



PS: Poster Basics



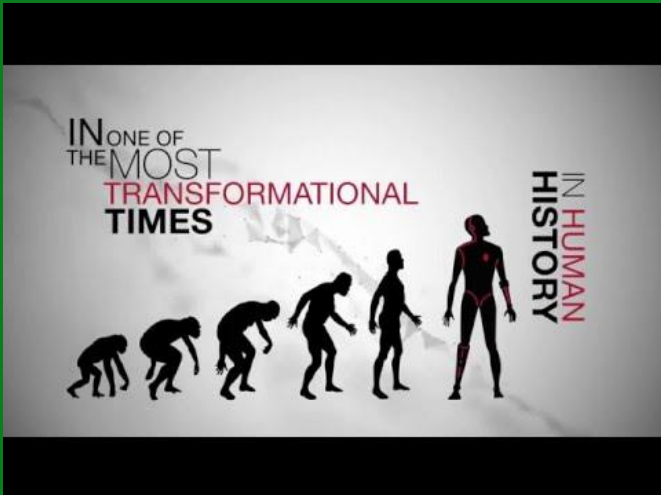
PS: Overlap Shapes (Layers)

LEARNING RESOURCES

Trends Shaping the Future of Work



Based on what you learned in the videos, think about two ways that work is different today.



Careers in Arts & Culture

Did you know?

- Over 500,000 Canadians work in occupations related to the cultural sector.
- **Culture** is an area that attracts many people.
- Many artists and cultural workers will tell you that their jobs provide **inspiration, independence and mobility**, as well as the chance to learn and work in many different places and with many different people.

Potential **challenges** of the cultural workplace include:

- unpredictable income;
- lack of work stability;
- long hours;
- self-employment, and the challenge of self-management;
- tight timelines;
- few or no benefits such as pensions,
- health plans and sick leave.



LEARNING RESOURCES

FUNDAMENTALS



HOW TO

Poster Design Tips



[How to Make an Eye Catching Poster](#)

[11 Tips for Creative Poster Design](#)

Learn more about the [creative process](#)



POSTER



Activity: Favourite Poster Designs

- Complete the “Effective Poster Examples” assignment on the Google Classroom.
- Share **TWO** examples and explain why you think they’re effective. Use some of the **elements & principles of design** in your answers.
- Remember to **cite your sources** by copying & pasting the original weblink url!



LEARNING RESOURCES

InDesign Information

Id BASIC TOOLS



Click [here](#) for an in depth introduction to Adobe InDesign.

INDESIGN

CS6 AND CC SHORTCUTS



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laptop

